

LAST NOTE

A few years back, I was sitting at café Le Morgan in Auroville with some Aurovillian friends and my family, soaking in the atmosphere and the coffee. It was very peaceful, made even more calm post a visit to the Matrimandir. Suddenly a man walked up and said: 'Monika Halan herself!'

We all looked up a bit shocked at this abrupt comment. Six heads turned to look at him. He then spoke further. 'You are the reason I am here.' It seems that he had called on my NDTV show, asking if he could retire early. He'd sent his portfolio and his pension amounts.

A bell rang in my head and I said, 'You're the army guy!' I remembered telling an army officer who wanted to take early retirement that his money was enough to go free. And here he was. In Auroville, living his dream life.

Each time I meet a reader or caller from my TV shows, or someone writes in to tell me that my writing or advice made a difference to their lives, I hit a personal high. I think I levitate a bit that day! One of the most common comments I get is around preventing people from making bad decisions. 'You are the reason I don't have ULIPs in my portfolio.' Or 'Because of you, I got saved from the insurance scam', or 'Your writing has made me a better investor'.

I have not met a single person who has said: 'You have made me rich overnight.' The goal is empowerment and financial freedom and not being suddenly super rich. Financial freedom and a feeling of being in control can happen even when you are not super rich.

Those who peddle dreams of making you rich, giving you the secret to becoming wealthy overnight, are pressing very old buttons. These buttons are greed and exclusivity. The greed button, when pressed, triggers the desire to get something by not doing much. It is the desire for disproportional gain.